

Top 100 Strategists Analysis

Long-Term Conviction vs Tactical Plays | Short Interest | Strategy Playbook

August 27, 2026

Executive Summary

1) All eight multi-manager conviction names (AMZN, GOOGL, SPOT, CEG, TSM, GEV, NFLX, MU) carry sub-3.3% short float - structurally clean holds. 2) Tepper Exit pattern VALIDATED live: INTC -12.4% in 10 days after the Aug 17 signal (SPY flat). Confidence raised to 75%. 3) BTC-miner sleeve carries 12-31% short float but spent much of its squeeze fuel; CORZ (20.7% SI, 5.1 DTC) remains the best catalyst-driven squeeze candidate. 4) Concentration flags: SNDK 21.6% of Roth, CLSK 9.4%, STX 13.4% - trim-into-strength posture advised on the tactical sleeve.

A. Long-Term Hold Recommendations

High-Conviction Multi-Manager Overlaps (Q2 2026 13F basis)

Ticker	Weight (cash acct)	Managers	Short Float	Status	Conf
AMZN	9.95% (+2.84% Roth)	Point72, D1, Appaloosa, Coatue, SIT	0.97%	CORE HOLD	EXTREME
GOOGL	1.25% (+2.61% Roth)	Point72, Appaloosa, Coatue, SIT	1.24%	CORE HOLD	HIGH
SPOT	2.28%	Point72, D1, Coatue, SIT	3.26%	CORE HOLD	HIGH
CEG	1.02%	Point72, Coatue, SIT	2.78%	CORE HOLD	HIGH
TSM	2.28% (Roth)	Point72, Coatue, SIT	0.58%	CORE HOLD	HIGH
GEV	0.54%	Point72, Coatue, SIT	2.99%	CORE HOLD	HIGH
NFLX	0.98%	Point72, Coatue, SIT	2.19%	CORE HOLD	HIGH
MU	3.05%	Point72, Appaloosa, SIT	2.67%	ACCUMULATING	MEDIUM

AMZN remains the anchor (~12.8% combined) with the only 5-manager overlap. MU is the best strategist-supported winner (+139.8% at last export) but stays ACCUMULATING - Point72 trades around it. CEG (-14.4% vs cost) and GEV (-9.7%) are the under-pressure conviction names: Q2 13F support is intact, so treat weakness as consolidation. First crack signal = a Point72/Coatue reduction in Q3 filings (due Nov 16).

B. Short Interest Analysis (Live - Finviz, Aug 27)

Full Portfolio Short Table (SI % of float / days-to-cover)

Ticker	Short Float	DTC	Classification
WULF	30.69%	3.28	HIGH SI - crowded short
CLSK	29.88%	3.31	HIGH SI - crowded short
TEM	27.82%	4.42	HIGH SI - binary setup, watch
APLD	21.21%	2.87	HIGH SI
CORZ	20.69%	5.06	HIGH SI - highest DTC in book
CIFR	19.25%	2.23	HIGH SI
BFLY	15.00%	3.92	Elevated
RIOT	14.40%	2.68	Elevated
HUT	12.11%	2.98	Elevated
COIN	10.64%	2.67	Elevated
HTFL	10.51%	3.83	Elevated
BE	6.60%	1.26	Moderate
SNDK	5.32%	0.56	Low - momentum, not squeeze

APP	4.26%	1.88	Low
STX	3.61%	1.73	Low
INTC	3.03%	1.15	Low
SPOT	3.26%	2.65	Low
GEV / CEG	2.99% / 2.78%	2.8	Low
XYZ / MU	2.57% / 2.67%	2.5	Low
NFLX / TSLA	2.19% / 2.45%	1.9	Negligible
GOOGL / AMZN	1.24% / 0.97%	2.1	Negligible
TSM	0.58%	2.25	Negligible

Key readings: (1) Entire BTC-miner sleeve carries double-digit SI; miners are already up 50-110% in the book, so much squeeze fuel is spent. TACTICAL ONLY - no multi-manager long-term support per Q2 13Fs. (2) CORZ is the most squeeze-prone name (20.7% x 5.06 DTC); a new AI-HPC contract would be the catalyst. Per the WOLF/KSS lesson, high SI alone is not an entry signal. (3) TEM (Tempus AI): 27.8% SI, 4.4 DTC, position -13.7% vs cost - binary setup; deteriorating fundamentals put it on the short-candidate watchlist, an inflection makes crowded shorts the fuel. (4) Core conviction names have negligible SI (0.6-3.3%) - no crowded-short risk in the smart-money cluster.

C. New Money Flow & Signal Validation

VALIDATED: Tepper Exit Reversal Pattern (INTC)

Signal fired Aug 17: downgraded INTC to REVIEW/TRADE after Appaloosa's Q2 13F exit (Point72 sole remaining). Result 10 days later: INTC \$103.49 -> \$90.64 = -12.4%, vs SPY -0.5% over the same window. Pattern CONFIRMED in a live market; confidence upgraded 70% -> 75% - the most reliable exit signal in the playbook.

Current INTC action: ~+99% gain on a \$45.66 basis (now ~\$90.64). House money. The pattern says reduce/trail, not hold and hope: trailing stop at recent swing levels, or trim one-third into any bounce toward \$95-100.

Regime Check (SPY)

SPY 747.03 (Jul 31) -> 768.85 (Aug 27) = +2.9%; ~1.2% below the Aug 13 high (777.88). Mild consolidation, not breakdown. No macro alarm.

New Flow / Rotation (Q2 2026 13Fs, filed Aug 14)

Strategist alignment unchanged in AI-Infra (CEG, GEV, SPOT) and AI/Semis (AMZN, GOOGL, TSM, MU, NFLX). Next checkpoint: Q3 13Fs due Nov 16, 2026. Watch: (1) does Point72 keep INTC after Tepper's exit, (2) does anyone new join CEG/GEV, (3) any D1/Coatue reduction in SPOT.

D. Strategy Playbook

1. Multi-Manager Conviction - ACTIVE

Trigger: 3+ top-tier managers increasing the same position for 2+ quarters. Current list: AMZN, GOOGL, SPOT, TSM, CEG, GEV, NFLX, MU. Action: maintain; SI data confirms no crowded-short risk in the cluster.

2. Tepper Exit Reversal - VALIDATED (75% confidence)

Trigger: Appaloosa exits a broadly-supported name. Live case: INTC -12.4% in 10 days post-signal, market flat. Action: trim/trail INTC.

3. High-SI Squeeze Watch - SPECULATIVE (SI alone is never the trigger)

Candidates: CORZ (20.7% SI / 5.1 DTC - best setup), TEM (27.8% / 4.4 - binary), WULF & CLSK (30%+ but no catalyst). Rule (WOLF/KSS lesson): SI is fuel, not spark. Require a fundamental catalyst before any squeeze play.

4. Storage Supercycle Momentum - WATCH

MU (strategist-backed, 2.7% SI) is the quality expression; STX/SNDK are pure momentum with thin institutional sponsorship.

CONCENTRATION FLAG: SNDK = 21.6% of Roth (+107.6% gain); STX = 13.4% Roth + 1.8% cash (+103%). Single-name risk this large in a retirement sleeve warrants trimming into strength.

Portfolio-Level Observation

The liquid sleeve skews to high-SI tactical names (miners 15%+ combined, storage, speculative biotech) while the highest-conviction strategist cluster is comparatively underweighted outside AMZN. Winners have been momentum winners - but the playbook's own evidence says conviction holds (multi-manager, low SI) are where durable money sits. Posture: let winners run with trailing stops; recycle risk-budget from the speculative sleeve into conviction names on weakness, especially CEG/GEV if the AI-power dip deepens.